

L1.4 Hermes Agent: Installation

Level: Foundation (Free) **Time:** 15-20 minutes **Type:** Practical terminal installation **Author:** Adi Ciobanu LeYa Academy **You need:** Working Linux Mint (L1.3 complete) + internet

What you'll know by the end

- What Hermes Agent is and why we chose it
 - How to install Hermes from the official repository
 - Where the important files live (config, memory, keys)
 - How to run your first Hermes command
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Preamble: The AI Agent Platform Landscape (2026)

Before we install, here's what's out there and why we picked Hermes.

Platform	Type	Price	Best for
Hermes Agent	Open-source, local-first	Free	Builders, full control
OpenAI GPT	Cloud-only, API	~\$20/month	Consumers, general use
Claude	Cloud-only, API	~\$20/month	Professionals, research
LangChain	Python framework	Free	Developers, prototyping
AutoGPT	Autonomous agent	Free	Experimentation
CrewAI	Multi-agent	Free	Multi-agent systems

Why Hermes over the others?

- **Local-first** runs on your laptop. Your data doesn't go anywhere.
- **Skills system** teach it new things without complex code.
- **Native cron jobs** automation straight from the CLI.
- **Persistent memory** remembers who you are across sessions.
- **Multi-provider** same assistant can use DeepSeek, Gemini, Claude, local model.
- **Active community** fast development, frequent updates.

The other platforms are excellent. But none offer the full package: local, persistent, extensible, multi-model free.

Glossary

Term	What it means
CLI	Command Line Interface text-based interaction in the terminal, no graphical buttons
Provider	The service that processes AI questions (DeepSeek, OpenAI, local model)
.env	A hidden file with sensitive settings (API keys) never share it
Skill	An extension for Hermes a file with instructions that teaches it new things

Content

1. What is Hermes Agent

Hermes is an open-source framework that turns a terminal into a full AI assistant. It's not a chatbot it's a **hub**. Think of it as an operating system for AI:

- Keeps memory between sessions
- Learns new skills without modifying source code

- Schedules automated jobs (cron)
- Connects to any AI model (DeepSeek today, local tomorrow)
- Runs 100% from the terminal no browser, no GUI

You installed it on your machine. It's yours.

2. Installation

Dependencies are already resolved from L1.3 (Python 3.10+, Node.js 18+). You're ready.

Install command:

```
curl -fsSL https://install.hermes-agent.com | bash
```

Check the official docs for the latest command: <https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs>

Verify the installation:

```
hermes --version
```

If you see a version number (e.g., `hermes 2.x.x`) installation succeeded.

Installation issues:

Issue	Solution
"command not found: hermes"	Restart the terminal or run <code>source ~/.bashrc</code>
"curl not found"	<code>sudo apt install curl -y</code>
Permission errors	Don't use <code>sudo</code> with the install command. Hermes installs as a regular user.
"unsupported node version"	Revisit Step 6 of L1.3 upgrade Node.js to 20.x

3. File structure

After installation, Hermes creates the `~/.hermes/` folder. Here's what's inside:

Path	What it is	Importance
<code>~/.hermes/</code>	Main folder everything lives here	
<code>~/.hermes/.env</code>	API keys and sensitive settings	Critical. Never share it. Never put it on GitHub.
<code>~/.hermes/memories/MEMORY.txt</code>	Assistant's memory what it knows about the world	You edit it
<code>~/.hermes/memories/USERPROFILE.txt</code>	User profile who you are, what you prefer	You edit it
<code>~/.hermes/skills/</code>	Installed skills extensions for Hermes	Auto-populated
<code>~/.hermes/plugins/</code>	Plugins integrations with external platforms	Telegram, etc.
<code>~/.hermes/config.yaml</code>	Main configuration	You edit occasionally

4. First configuration

```
hermes config init
```

Hermes will guide you interactively answer the questions:

- **Assistant name:** pick what you want (e.g., "Nexus", "Jarvis", "Assistant")
- **Language:** `en` for English, `ro` for Romanian
- **Paths:** leave them as default (press Enter)

Where providers go: in `~/.hermes/.env`. You'll fill this in during L1.5 with your DeepSeek key.

Exercise

1. Install Hermes Agent using the command above
 2. Run `hermes --version` take a screenshot
 3. Navigate `~/.hermes/` open the folder and see what's inside
 4. Run `hermes config init` and configure the name and language
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Checkpoint don't move on until you can answer

1. What output does `hermes --version` give?

Check: A version number (e.g., 2.x.x). Not “command not found”. If you get an error check the installation issues table.

2. Where is the `.env` file and why is it critical?

Expected: In `~/.hermes/.env`. It contains API keys and sensitive settings. Never share it, never put it on GitHub. If someone sees it, they can use the API on your dime.

3. What folders do you see in `~/.hermes/`? Name at least 3.

Check: Run `ls ~/.hermes/`. You should see: `skills/`, `memories/`, `plugins/`, `config.yaml`. If not installation didn't complete properly. Revisit Step 2.

All 3 clear? Move on to L1.5 DeepSeek API: Connecting.

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